EIGHT-WEEK COMMUNITY LEARNING PROGRAM

Digital Confidence for the AI Era

A practical learning journey for adults who want to feel more capable with everyday technology, online safety, and responsible AI use.

8 WEEKS | PLAIN LANGUAGE | NO TECH BACKGROUND

PURPOSE

Help people understand enough to participate, decide, and act for themselves.

Created by Rachel Ryan | TechTidy community learning project

September 2026

WHY THIS EXISTS

Access is not the same as confidence.

Many essential tasks now assume people can manage accounts, files, online forms, cloud services, security decisions, and constant software change. The program builds understanding first, then guided practice.

WHO THIS GUIDE IS FOR

This guide is for prospective learners, community partners, and facilitators considering a TechTidy pilot. It is a program overview, not a participant workbook.

INTENDED LEARNERS

01

People who feel left behind

Technology has changed faster than the support available to them.

02

Older adults

Learners who want more independence with everyday digital tasks and online safety.

03

Newcomers

People navigating unfamiliar services, communication, employment, and online systems.

04

Community learners

Adults with different devices, experiences, accessibility needs, and goals.

LEARNING DESIGN RESPONSE

UNDERSTAND

Explain what is happening and why it matters.

PRACTISE

Try one useful task with patient guidance.

TRANSFER

Apply the idea to a new situation independently.

THE FULL PATHWAY

Eight weeks, from foundations to practical AI.

Each week connects to the next. AI is introduced only after learners have practised digital organization, communication, and online safety.

01	**Start with confidence** Digital baseline and technology foundations	FOUNDATIONS
02	**Organize digital information** Files, folders, cloud storage, and syncing	FOUNDATIONS
03	**Protect yourself online** Scams, passwords, multi-factor authentication	SAFETY
04	**Communicate and work** Email, calendars, documents, and collaboration	PRACTICE
05	**Understand AI** What it is, what it is not, and where it appears	AI LITERACY
06	**Use AI for one task** Prompt, review, verify, and improve	AI PRACTICE
07	**Apply AI thoughtfully** Work, learning, access, and human judgment	APPLICATION
08	**Build a personal toolkit** Choose safe next steps and continue independently	TRANSFER

PROGRAM LOGIC

Confidence grows through repeated small successes - not through exposure to more tools.

FOUNDATIONS AND SAFETY

Build capability before adding complexity.

WEEK 01

Digital confidence baseline

OUTCOME

Learners can identify what they already know, one barrier, and one practical goal.

EXAMPLE ACTIVITY

My technology map: mark familiar tasks, tasks that need support, and one task to practise this week.

WEEK 02

Files, cloud, and organization

OUTCOME

Learners can create, name, find, move, and recognize a synced file.

EXAMPLE ACTIVITY

Find it twice: save a practice document, locate it from a folder, then locate the synced copy.

WEEK 03

Online safety and scams

OUTCOME

Learners can pause, inspect common warning signs, and choose a safe next step.

EXAMPLE ACTIVITY

Message check: compare two fictional notices and identify urgency, suspicious links, and verification options.

WEEK 04

Communication and productivity

OUTCOME

Learners can complete one everyday communication task with less friction.

EXAMPLE ACTIVITY

Plan and send: create a calendar event, add a clear reminder, and draft a concise follow-up email.

AI LITERACY AND TRANSFER

Use AI with context, verification, and human judgment.

WEEK 05

AI foundations

OUTCOME

Learners can explain generative AI in plain language and name at least two limitations.

EXAMPLE ACTIVITY

Human or system? sort everyday examples, then discuss prediction, patterns, hallucinations, and bias.

WEEK 06

Practical AI for everyday life

OUTCOME

Learners can write a clear request, review the response, and improve it without sharing private data.

EXAMPLE ACTIVITY

Explain it clearly: ask AI to simplify a fictional notice, then check every factual claim.

WEEK 07

AI for work and learning

OUTCOME

Learners can choose when AI may help, when search is better, and when a person is required.

EXAMPLE ACTIVITY

Choose the method: compare AI, search, and human expertise across six realistic scenarios.

WEEK 08

Personal digital toolkit

OUTCOME

Learners can document safe tools, support routes, and two next steps they can complete independently.

EXAMPLE ACTIVITY

My next-step plan: build a one-page toolkit with trusted links, security habits, and a practice goal.

FACILITATION THAT REDUCES PRESSURE.

The program is structured enough to guide and flexible enough to meet people where they are.

FACILITATION APPROACH

- Explain before clicking. Give the task a purpose and context.
- Demonstrate, practise, repeat. Learners use their own words and actions.
- Normalize questions. Confusion is treated as design information, not failure.
- Offer choice. Activities can be observed, guided, or completed independently.
- End with transfer. Learners identify where the skill applies next.

ACCESSIBILITY APPROACH

- Plain language with unfamiliar terms explained immediately.
- Large, readable materials with strong contrast and generous spacing.
- Keyboard-aware demonstrations and alternatives to mouse-only actions.
- Multiple formats including spoken explanation, demonstration, and print.
- Flexible pacing with repetition and optional support time.

PRIVACY, CONSENT, AND RESPONSIBLE AI

MINIMIZE	Use fictional examples for practice. Do not enter personal, confidential, workplace, health, or financial information into AI tools.
EXPLAIN	Make data use, account requirements, tool limitations, and uncertainty visible before an activity begins.
CONSENT	Do not record sessions or reuse participant stories without specific, informed permission. Participation in examples remains optional.
VERIFY	Check important information against an official or trusted source. AI output is a draft or explanation, not final authority.
DECIDE	Keep human judgment in the process. Learners should know when to stop and ask a qualified person for help.

PROGRESS AND PRACTICE

Measure useful change, not technical performance.

HOW PROGRESS WOULD BE EVALUATED

START

Short confidence baseline and one learner-selected goal.

WEEKLY

One observable task, a confidence check, and a question to revisit.

END

Repeat selected tasks, compare confidence, and identify an independent next step.

IMPROVE

Optional feedback on clarity, pace, accessibility, and remaining barriers.

SAMPLE PARTICIPANT EXERCISE - WEEK 6

Ask. Check. Decide.

Scenario: You receive a fictional notice about a new online service. The wording is difficult, and you want AI to explain it without exposing private information or inventing details.

1. REMOVE

   Circle names, addresses, account numbers, reference numbers, or other identifying details. Replace them with neutral placeholders.

2. ASK

   Use: "Explain this fictional notice in plain language. Do not invent missing details. List anything I need to verify."

3. CHECK

   Compare dates, requirements, links, and contact details with the official source. Mark anything the AI added or changed.

4. DECIDE

   Write the next safe action in your own words. If the notice affects rights, money, health, or eligibility, contact the responsible organization.

REFLECTION

What did the AI make clearer? What still required checking? What information should never be shared?

CURRENT STATUS

Designed and ready to test - not yet proven.

The curriculum structure, learning outcomes, delivery principles, and evaluation approach are ready for a first community pilot. The pilot exists to test assumptions and improve the program before wider delivery.

READY NOW

- Eight-week learning sequence
- Weekly outcomes and activities
- Facilitation and accessibility principles
- Privacy and responsible AI boundaries
- Baseline and end-of-program evaluation

THE PILOT MUST VALIDATE

- Pace and session length
- Relevance for the learner group
- Device and access barriers
- Clarity of activities and materials
- Support needs and useful adaptations

FOR PROSPECTIVE LEARNERS AND COMMUNITY PARTNERS

Express interest or discuss a pilot.

Share the learner group, setting, access needs, or topic you are considering. Submitting the form is an enquiry only - it does not commit you or TechTidy to participate or deliver the program.

OPEN THE INTEREST FORM

https://techtidy.ca/digital-confidence/#interest

Created by Rachel Ryan

Research, learning design, content, accessibility, and development

TechTidy community learning project